FINANCIAL LITERACY PROJECT: THE DIGITAL-PHYSICAL DOLLAR DISCONNECT

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I. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Issue

This generation of **middle school children** are the first to be exposed, at a young age, to a digital economy. As the payment of goods and services have shifted from physical cash to digital methods, a **disconnect** from the tangible value of the dollar has been created with this group. Therefore, they have become habituated to **Frictionless Spending**, or spending without psychological or physical resistance. This may create a treacherous future for this age group, as their awareness of monetary value gradually **diminishes** with the growing digital economy.

Target Audience

The target audience for this project is **students grades 6th to 9th**, typically ranging from **ages 11 to 15**. During this stage of life, many students have **limited experience** with managing and handling money independently because, with the growing digital economy, they receive limited exposure to physical cash payments. On top of this, most financial decisions are handled by parents or guardians. Because of this, money often feels **abstract**, making it difficult for students to understand the **true value** of money. Many students in this age group spend money without understanding the effort required to earn it through the various methods, such as a job. This lack of direct experience with budgeting, saving, and spending creates a **critical gap** in financial understanding. In regards to this selection, we specifically choose this group because this is the age when children start to acquire their own money. Additionally, many young individuals receive phones at this time, exposing them to new abilities and tools. According to Pew Research Center, **95%** of U.S. teens in middle school or early high school had access to a smartphone in late 2024. Considering that owning a smartphone is no longer a luxury but a general necessity for many, this number has been growing and **will continue to grow**. Recognizing both of these emergences is crucial; since they tend to spend more and have the ability to do so through smartphones and other portable technology, they are inclined to resort to digital spending. This in turn reduces the likelihood of physical cash usage, making the value of the dollar **harder to interpret**. So, out of all age groups, people aged 11 to 15 require the most consideration and preparation for the growing digital economy.

1 OUR GOAL 1

Connection

Establish a tangible connection between digital spending and the value of the dollar for at least 50 students in the New Jersey area, as measured through the baseline form. "Connection" is the **ultimate purpose** of our efforts. This aspect will consequently make the target audience resort to physical cash spending **more often**.

Awareness

Increase student awareness of the danger of impulsive triggers for at least 50% of users. By highlighting in the site how maintenance of this habit can gradually pay a debt to their future, we are instilling them with a **"financial shock"** that ultimately **surges student awareness.**



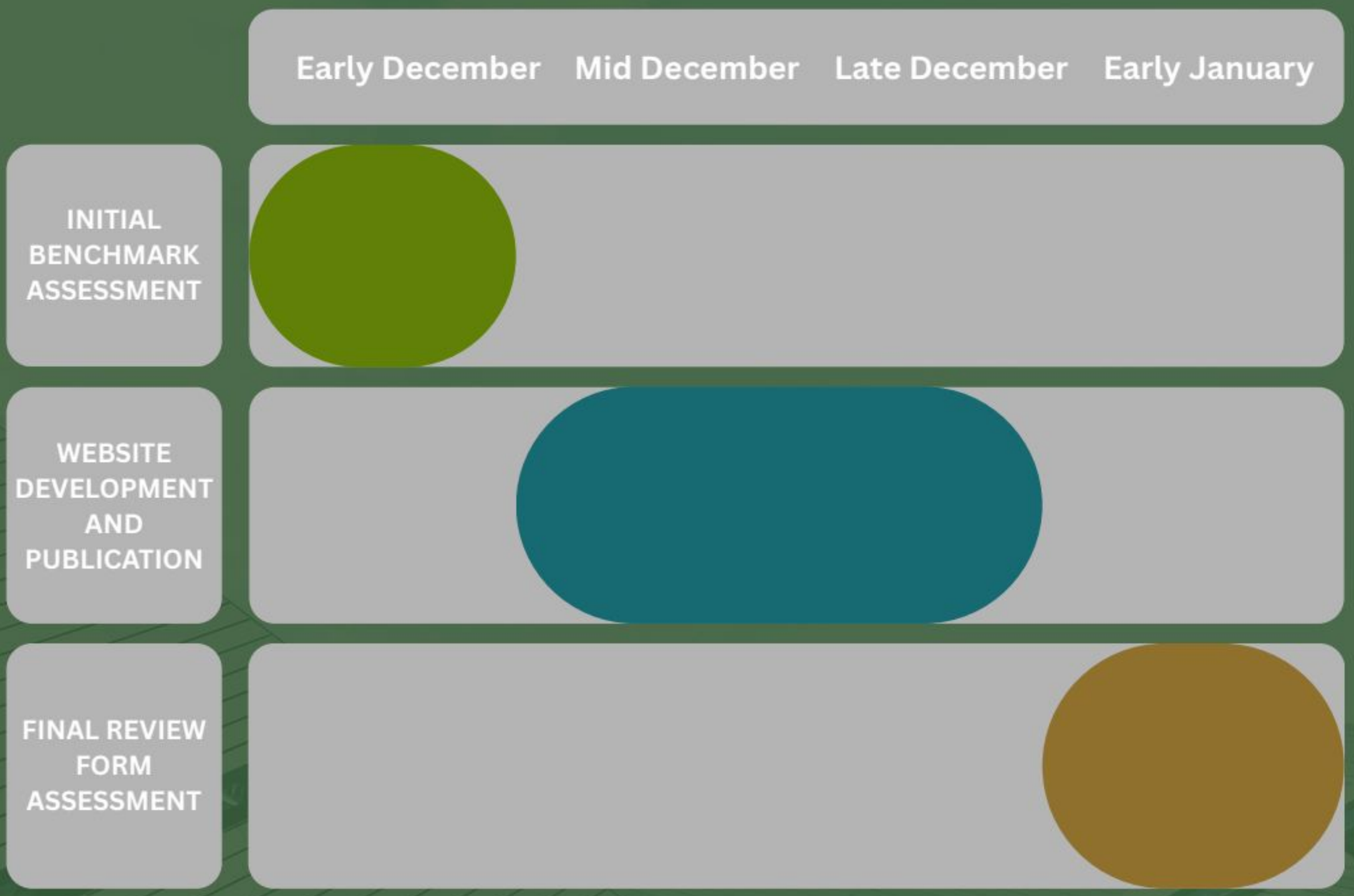
Sensitization

Introduce the "Pain of Paying" and "Frictionless Spending" to the digital-first generation by having at least 30 students utilize our website. We will offer them tools, such as a wage calculator, to teach them about earning money and how it holds value. Conversely, this also instills a **stronger connection** to the dollar, thus creating a **psychological pain** from losing physical cash.

Habituation

Ensure at least 75% of participants report a change in their digital purchasing habits during a follow-up survey. We included this aspect to ensure retention remains in **the long-term**, not just for a brief period.

PROJECT TIMELINE



Week of December 8, 2025

Milestone: Pre-Questionnaire Survey

Designed survey questionnaire focused on spending habits and money awareness and reviewed questions for age appropriateness. We then distributed the survey to collect and organize responses and identify trends and gaps.

Week of December 15, 2025

Milestone: Educative Website

This contains content research, website development, and design, including our “Hours to Buy” calculator. Website testing and publishing also occurred.

Week of January 5, 2026

Milestone: Post-Questionnaire Survey

We created a questionnaire based on content learnt to measure effectiveness of the website. This included user feedback questions which were used to refine the website for errors and misconceptions.

II. INITIATING

Statement of the Problem:

Over the past two decades, there has been a shift of spending from physical cash to digital currency.



Considering this change, teenagers, specifically those who fall in the 6th to 9th grade range, have been more exposed to digital, Frictionless Spending as opposed to cash spending. Consequently, this demographic is less able to interpret the tangible value of a dollar, for their spending has primarily been through credit cards, "taps" of a phone, and numerous mobile applications that perform digital transactions, such as Venmo and PayPal. Neurologically, in an MIT study on the effect of credit card spending, Sloan professor Drazen Prelec concluded that "the opportunity to use a credit card specifically engaged known reward brain networks, and especially those that are involved in anticipation and craving." For a maturing brain, this can be very dangerous, as crucial cognitive development occurs during this age, especially for financial literacy and spending habits. This abstract spending has cultivated impulse spending that produced a digital/physical disconnect.

The widespread use of debit cards, credit cards, and mobile payment transactions have reduced the need for individuals to pay with money. While this shift has increased efficiency, it has also altered how younger generations perceive money. Without the physical exchange of cash, spending has become increasingly abstract, particularly for students falling in ages 11-15 that are still developing foundational financial skills.

This issue is especially pervasive throughout grades 6-9, a demographic that has grown up entirely within a digital environment. Many students in this age range have limited experience earning money through work or making long-term financial decisions. As a result, money is often perceived more as a number than as a symbol of hard work and time. The disconnect makes it difficult for students to understand the real world problems of their spending habits.



We view this as a prevalent issue because understanding this foundational economic concept is crucial; without the comprehension of the dollar's value, this emerging generation will maintain these deficient spending habits, which could result in debt accumulation and poor financial literacy.

Purpose

Behind The Price's purpose is to **educate** students throughout grades 6-9 on the **true value of money** by making it feel **tangible** rather than abstract. Our project will use real world examples and simple financial tools, accessible to everyone, to help students understand the **relationship** between money and all the decisions they make without realizing. By showing how everyday purchases connect to basic financial decisions, our executions will be primarily designed to **fill the gap** between digital spending and real-world value. Our goal is to **increase financial awareness** at a young age, preparing students to make important financial decisions in the future.

PROJECT

Rationale

Behind The Price aims to begin with the **basic concepts** of financial literacy and go deeper into the concepts students misunderstand. Before we built the website, we created a Google Form to collect data, and we found that roughly **25%** of students ranging **grades 6-9** showed a general understanding of financial literacy. We specifically chose this target audience because it relates perfectly to the digital economy.

SCOPE

Expected Benefits

By supplementing the younger generation with the sufficient knowledge to make **well-informed** financial decisions, we are in turn contributing to a **better future**, for the adults of the upcoming decades will have strengthened their monetary understanding. They will also be able to apply their skills to maintain society's understanding of **prudent spending habits**. Most importantly, by utilizing our resources, users will be able to better grasp the notion of the **pain of paying**, or the psychological sting received from losing cash for a transaction. This behavioral mechanism is paramount for the future generation, especially when considering the **growing digital economy**.

III. PLANNING AND ORGANIZING

Project Goals:



Connections

Make money feel tangible rather than abstract by establishing a connection to spending.



Awareness

Increase awareness of the danger of impulse spending by highlighting its effects.



Sensizitization

Make the dollar's worth palpable by introducing the "Pain of Paying" and "Frictionless Spending."



Habituation

Follow up to ensure students obtained a positive and long-term change in spending behavior.

We aspire to help students CASH in on their potential by eliminating their habit of Frictionless Spending.

Motives for C.A.S.H.

These goals, **CASH**, were specifically chosen to work together as a **unified structure** rather than isolated objectives which don't connect to each other. "Connection" establishes **relevance**; "Awareness" builds **understanding;** "Sensitization" creates **emotional impact**; and "Habituation" ensures **behavioral change**. The project seeks to **empower** students to make informed financial decisions by equipping them with key financial concepts and awareness. Beyond improving immediate **financial literacy**, the long term goal is to teach them to make **responsible financial decisions**, reduce the **likelihood of poor spending habits**, and **promote** **thoughtful financial decision** making that extends beyond the classroom environment.

Project Mission

The primary goal of our project is to **increase financial literacy** among students **grades 6 to 9** by teaching them the fundamental concepts of financial literacy. Through an interactive website, we aim to fulfill the **C.A.S.H.** goals and help students better understand the relationship between saving, spending, and earning. Additional goals include **improving price awareness** and engaging students in an **interactive manner** rather than passive instruction. Ultimately, our project seeks to instill **core financial principles** in students and promote more through financial decision making, going beyond solely our primary goal.

HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT PLAN

Vishaan



Researcher & Data Analyst

- **Took lead on project analysis**
- **Researched evidence to utilize**
- **Created charts and graphs**

Vaibhav



Marketing & Implementation Lead

- **Designed the website**
- **Designed and created the calculator**
- **Managed outreach to various sources**

Manan



Project Manager

- **Handled document structure**
- **Kept group on task**
- **Kept up with timeline and deadlines**

Strengths & Skills

- **Research**
- **Technical Writing**
- **Organization**
- **Graphic Design**
- **Creativity**

- **Website Design**
- **Graphic Design**
- **Communication**
- **Public Speaking**
- **Detail-Oriented**

- **Time Management**
- **Critical Thinking**
- **Attention to Detail**
- **Problem-Oriented Mindset**
- **Reliability**

SCHEDULE: MILESTONES

Phase 1:
Data Accumulation

Our first short-term goal was to gather data to set an initial baseline of our target audience. In order to complete this, we crafted a Google Form Survey, questioning respondents on the value of the dollar, inflation, methods of payment, and more. Additionally, to appeal to the age group, we included familiar references and trends to maximize authentic engagement. Upon completion of this form, we then commenced outreach for poll responses throughout the specific week. The acquisition of responses can primarily be attributed to social media marketing towards the target audience, as well as word of mouth promotion.

Phase 2:
Website Design & Launch

After acquiring adequate data from phase 1, we benchmarked the level of financial literacy for the target audience. Based on these results, we tailored our website content and design according to the weak points identified in the survey. This ensures that most website users receive the most value from their experience, thus allowing us to fulfill our goals.

Phase 3:
Post-Implementation Impact Assessment

In order to measure the effectiveness of the website, we implemented another form to measure not just the retention level of the users, but also their feedback and sentiment. This form encompasses similar topics, such as "the Pain of Paying," methods of payment, and "Frictionless Spending," as well as feedback questions to improve the website. Optimizing the users' first-hand experience, we then utilized their input as advice to refine the website. Through the continuous improvement process, we guarantee that the website maintains relevance, satisfaction, and the utmost benefit to the users.

SCHEDULE: MILESTONES' TIMELINE

Phase 1

Week of December 1, 2025

Initiation & Problem Identification

- Defined target audience
- Defined our abstract dollar problem

Week of December 8, 2025

Survey Development + Distribution & Research

- Designed and released Google Form survey questions
- Researched spending behaviors
- Performed Data Analysis

Phase 2

Week of December 15, 2025

Planning & Content Creation

- Assigned Team Roles & Responsibilities
- Began Website Content & Layout

Week of December 22, 2025

Website Interactivity & Finalization

- Programmed and Embedded the "Hours to Buy" Calculator
- Added visuals & icons
- Finalized content and design

Phase 3

Week of December 29, 2025

Website Launch & Outreach

- Officially published website after review
- Promoted website with marketing techniques
- Encouraged use of the calculator along with the website

Week of January 5, 2026

Follow-Up Survey Administration & Data Collection

- Distributed a follow-up survey to same audience
- Ensured questions were similar to the initial form
- Recorded feedback and opinions to evaluate effectiveness

QUALITY MANAGEMENT PLAN

General Quality Goals

Our Quality Management Plan focuses on measuring both the **effectiveness** and **usability** of our website. Key metrics include improvements on financial understanding through **prior** and **post survey results**, **user engagement** through interactive tools, and **user feedback** on accessibility. Some specific improvements in the students that we prioritized were their understanding in **financial knowledge**, demonstration of proficient awareness on spending decisions, and **understanding** that money represents time and effort over a digital number. We also ensured interaction with the website either by trying out the **Hours To Buy calculator** or just reading information. To do this, we evaluated the website's **accuracy and ease of navigation** to ensure it remained age appropriate and informative at all times. These metrics allow us to assess the quality of our project and make adjustments as needed.

Connection Quality Goal

In order to receive only the most insightful and detailed responses, we went through individual responses and removed the broadest answers. These responses essentially broke through the contingency plan "barrier," reflecting minimal care and effort.

Awareness Quality Goal

In order to maximize functionality of the work to achieve this goal, we provided extreme emphasis of the users' future, explaining how it is metaphorically "leaking." This idea is on the very first website page, which enhances the likelihood of their awareness.

Sensitization Quality Goal

To make the ideas of "Frictionless Spending" and the "Pain of Paying" engraved in the students' minds, we repeatedly crafted the most apt descriptions of the two concepts, refining the definitions after each trial. In order to ensure it provided the most insight, we had a pilot implementation group select the most precise and clear descriptions.

Habituation Quality Goal

To confirm an accurate improvement in digital purchasing habits, we implemented our follow-up survey and compared this to baseline data. By recognizing the major change in their digital spending, we are guaranteeing that we don't give instill a shock, but also long-term knowledge.

RISK MANAGEMENT PLAN

Risk	Risk Level	Potential Impact	Contingency Plan
Limited Audience Engagement		Considering their young age, the audience may not be appealed to the content and may find it dull. This would then deem the project ineffective and inconsequential.	There are numerous ways we mitigated this risk. We added color to the entire site and important aspects of content, thus creating appealing visuals. Additionally, we highlighted beneficial tools to utilize, such as our drop-downs and interactive calculator, which would increase engagement. As for a more natural implementation, we spoke in second-person to create a connection with our audience and keep them appealed.
Inauthentic or Biased Survey Data		If our survey data may be inconsistent or false, then we would have a false baseline of the target audience. This would in turn create a domino effect of incorrect research and knowledge provided to these individuals. This could also be applied to the final results form, where we would receive an incorrect measure of of our effect on website users.	At the beginning of both our baseline and post-analysis metrics, we included a statement expressing our need for their integrity. Furthermore, in all of the form's quiz questions (non-opinion questions), we included the answer choice of "I don't know." This allows for more accurate data because instead of respondents guessing, they have the option to express their uncertainty and lack of knowledge. It is also important to consider that this target demographic, as seen from personal account and observational data, often ignores directions. To improve the likelihood that they read this introductory information, the first question acts as a "Compliance Check," asking if users read and acknowledged the top directions. This requires respondents to recognize how they should approach the survey, thus solidifying the reliability of it.
Varying Levels of Financial Knowledge		Due to the comprehension gap between the sixth to ninth grade students, learning material may be too inconsistent. More specifically, if the content is too sophisticated, the younger target audience may have difficulty understanding the material. On the other hand, if the information is too simple, older groups may find the information redundant and futile.	In order to relieve this issue, we created a balance between simplification and sophistication. In the website, there are various colors, bolding, underlines, and symbolic images implemented to highlight important concepts, which calls attention to crucial information in a simpler manner. We also established a clean look for the website, ensuring simplicity and manageability. As for the more sophisticated side, we included some advanced and precise terminology to establish an insightful and convincing tone. We also previewed the important topics of multiple pages to establish the main idea of each section.
Ineffective Outreach Efficacy		If our marketing techniques, specifically our social media promotion, fails, then there would be minimal respondents to the survey and minimal users of the site. This would then provide less data for our project, and ultimately, the project would be less effective.	In order to prevent such a detrimental impact from this risk, we optimized our social media familiarity and marketing expertise to generate a sufficient amount of viewers of our posts, thus providing an inflow of website users. By incorporating hashtags such as "middle-school" and "school" into our post captions, our content was more likely to appear on the target audience's "for-you page." Additionally, by putting lengthy paragraphs into our captions, the TikTok algorithm automatically made our content more likely to appear on the demographic's social media pages. In the end, we were able to mitigate this issue, for we generated a total of 912 views.

PROPOSED PROJECT BUDGET

The proposed project budget for our personal financial literacy project is minimal, and could potentially require no monetary input at all. Our project was created using Canva, a free design software. The surveys were created in Google Forms, and we used Google Sites to build the site. The only potential expenses considered include premium Canva design tools and a domain name to improve the presentation. Most domains are only $4-5 and a premium Canva subscription would only cost $12.99/month. Marketing for our website and surveys were conducted through digital promotion with platforms like TikTok and Instagram, as well as family communication channels. The budget ranges from $0 to a maximum of $30, assuming a two-month Canva subscription and a domain purchase. The project involved a substantial investment of time, which represents an important opportunity cost. Each team member dedicated multiple hours to researching financial literacy concepts, designing the website, creating content, and analyzing data. This time could have been allocated toward other academic responsibilities, extracurricular activities, or paid work; however, we chose to invest our time into the development of this project due to its educational value and long-term impact. By prioritizing this project, we essentially "paid" with time instead of money. This low-cost approach ensures our project is stable, efficient, and accessible.

Resource Distribution Plan

Resource	Purpose
• Google Forms • Notion Software • Human Ability • Google Sheets • Social Media Platforms ◦ TikTok, Instagram ◦ Snapchat • Pilot Implementation Group	• To bring in responses and data • To help track incomplete work • To work, develop project, and analyze • To organize data and act as a calculator • To create communication routes ◦ To promote forms and website ◦ To help the group communicate • To test the website prior to launch

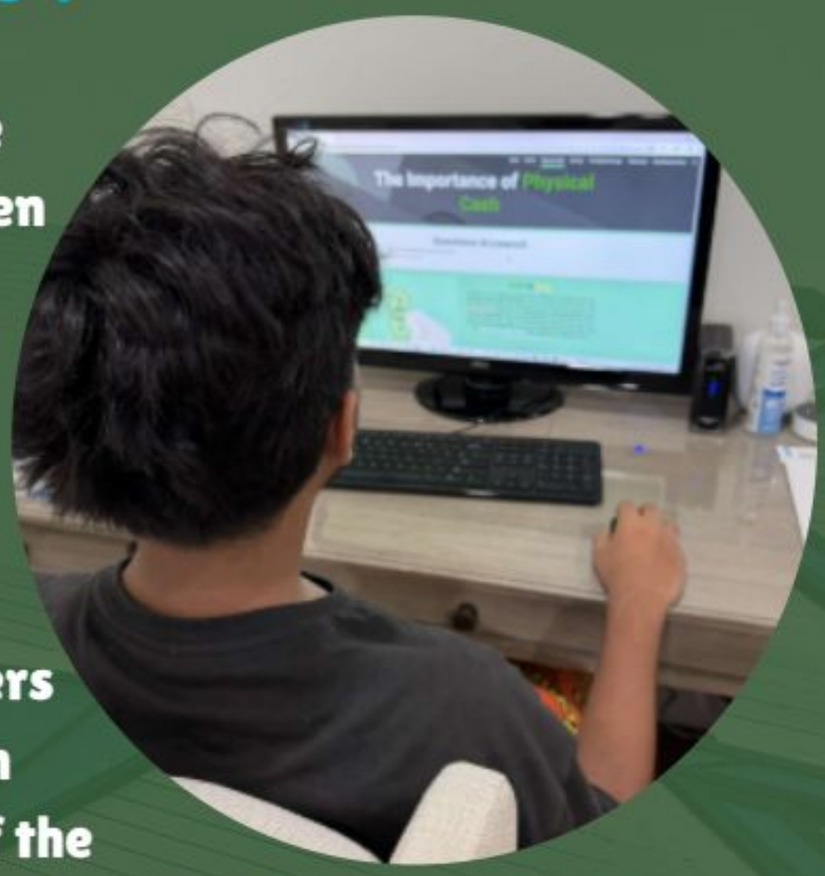


IV. EXECUTION





Our project plan was implemented through a structured, step-by-step process over a 2 month period. We began phase one by researching financial awareness among students in grades 6 to 9. This was to familiarize ourselves with the problem at hand and the content associated with it. In order to acquire quantitative data, we began crafting our Google Form, asking specific questions focused around the value of the dollar. After distributing the Google Form survey through TikTok marketing and word-of-mouth promotion, based on the data of our 51 participants, roughly a quarter of them correctly answered a question based on the value of the dollar and earning. After analyzing the results on questions like this, we identified key gaps in financial understanding, which we utilized to begin phase two: the website.



The tasks for creation were assigned on individual strengths, where Vishaan and Manan provided a foundation through titles and written content and Vaibhav completed it through visuals. The website was developed in stages in increments of each page, tested for usability and strong appeal, and would be revised based on phase three feedback to ensure clarity and accessibility. After finalization and minor revisions, we began to work on our calculator tool to address the most incorrectly answered questions. The calculator teaches users how many federal work hours they must perform to obtain a certain good or service at a certain price point. This emphasizes the value of the dollar, which can be earned through work. After finalizing all teachable and visual components of the website, we began distribution through similar marketing as the previous form. This enabled us to commence phase three, which was the final review form survey. We incorporated similar questions as the first form to record the level of improvement from the respondents. On top of this, we added a feedback section that measures their sentiment of the quality and content of each page. In order to verbally express their thoughts, we included an open-ended question.



This was used for us to improve on the website's contents, thus ameliorating its weaker aspects and keeping it intuitive and effective for the intended audience. This final review form was included in the website, so when users open the website, they take the first form, then go through the website experience, then take the final review form.

V. MONITORING & CONTROLLING



MONITORING



SCHEDULE

We monitored our schedule by creating a project timeline with clearly defined milestones for each phase of our project. We looked at the Gantt Chart as a basis for how behind or ahead we were during the week, allowing us to adjust accordingly. It was also used to help us allocate time based on weaknesses and track the time it took to complete each part of the project. We also utilized our Google Docs Task Assigner to get a view of what work had to be done for the given week. Through group-chat communication, progress was tracked through regular check-ins, allowing us to identify delays early on and adjust responsibilities as needed. This ensured that all major tasks were completed by their soft due dates and that the project stayed on schedule.

BUDGET

Our project budget was monitored by prioritizing the use of free digital tools and tracking any optional expenses throughout the project. Since most resources, such as surveys, collaboration tools, and website development, were available at no cost, we ensured that we remained without our previously mentioned budget of thirty dollars. This approach allowed us to keep total costs minimal while maintaining a professional quality style.

PROJECT QUALITY

Project quality was monitored using key performance metrics like user engagement, clarity of content, and improvement in financial literacy. Above all, we reviewed participant sentiment to ensure people were getting a considerable level of information that could benefit them through a prolonged period of time. We also consistently performed functionality checks on the forms, website, and calculator, ensuring they were working and accurate. Lastly, we ensured the material was age appropriate for all grades. More specifically, we assessed their feedback on the tools and content to validate the website's feasibility. Ultimately, revisions were made based on feedback and testing results to be certain the website was accurate and effective.



CONTROLLING



Poor Audience Engagement

We encountered numerous **difficulties** in our implementation of our personal financial literacy project, ranging from student engagement to **technical** and **temporal limitations**. Our **plan** was to reach students through **social media** and expand form outreach, but we quickly realized that students weren't engaging with **financial topics**, in part due to the age gap between us and in part due to the nature of the **topics** being discussed. To **remedy** this, we shifted our plan to include **social** and **familial circles**, aiming to reach students that way. We also appealed to students by using **contemporary memes** like "67" and prominent video games. This appeal **boosted** engagement from this group, for our form not only was familiar, but also **entertaining** to some extent.

Team Disconnection Crisis

In addition, we had limited time to develop a website due to **scheduling conflicts** and **access limitations**. Two of our group members were **unable** to access **project resources** due to being out of the country, which left us with a week to finish the project proposal. We **adhered** to the original plan, though, and used **project management** tools to coordinate between ourselves and optimize **workflow**. More specifically, we used the Google Docs Task Assigner. This gave each member a clear view of what work was **incomplete**, what they were required to do, and what work had been done. Additionally, we included **soft due dates** to ensure we were on **task** and remained **productive**. We also **utilized** a Notion chart to list all tasks at hand, as well as **specific requirements** and details crucial to consider when working. Also, to **mitigate** the international issue, the remaining team member **redistributed tasks responsibilities** to maintain on track, creating a **fair balance** while providing him with more ability to make progress. **Critical tasks**, such as survey analysis and website development, were **prioritized**, while less important components were **simplified**. We also consistently coordinated in a casual group chat to keep up to date on tasks.

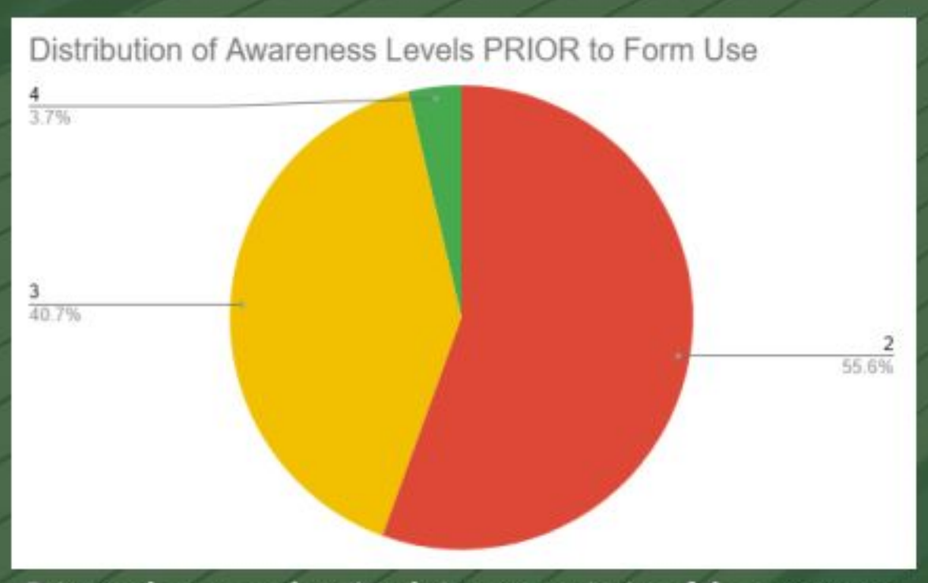
Missing Content Emergency

Two days before the scheduled website launch and promotion, we realized that an **instrumental component** of the website, the Takeaways page, was **missing**. So, to combat this conflict, we **implemented resource leveling**. In particular, we took some of our less **crucial** tasks, such as **coloring** and **image selection**, and put them at lower priority. We then shifted our **focus** to the Takeaways tab, where we began **summarizing** the important topics to repeat. We then listed them on the tab in a bulleted list. Since the entire website was completed, we then went back to **coloring** and **image selection**, where we finished all website tasks of various **priorities**.

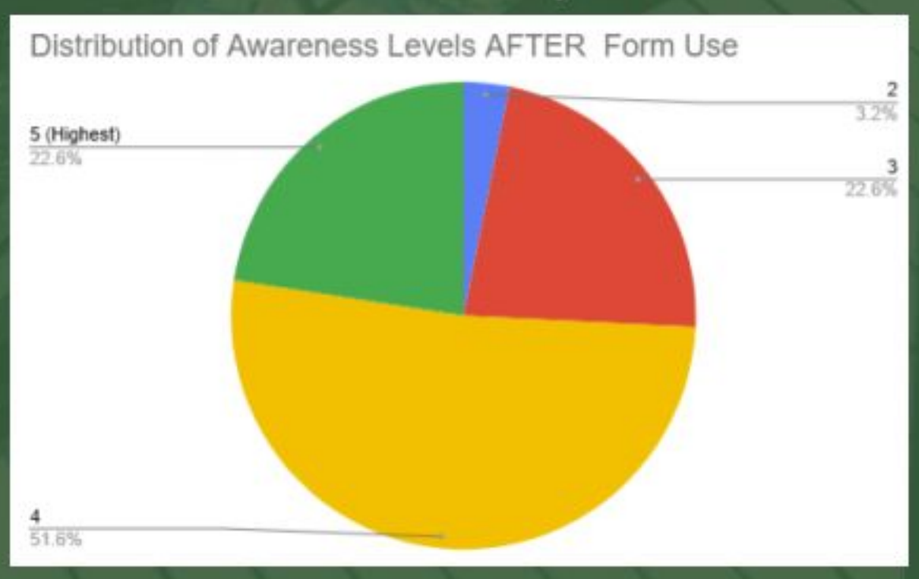
VI. CLOSING THE PROJECT

EVALUATION OF KEY METRICS

The evaluation of key metrics showcases that the project effectively met most of its quality objectives, for we accomplished 3 out of our 4 CASH goals. For "connection," we did aspired for 50 students to participate in the baseline form, which measured our success in this aspect. Fortunately, we narrowly surpassed our goal, acquiring 51 respondents. This means we were able to introduce this idea to the successful amount of people. As for the "awareness," we elevated awareness of impulse trigger dangers for more than half of the final review form respondents. More specifically, 67% of respondents reported increased awareness for their financial literacy, thus insinuating our attention boost. For "sensitization," we were able to relay "Frictionless Spending" and the "Pain of Paying" to 30 students, as recorded through the Final Review Form. Engagement metrics, such as the amount of people who responded to our survey and who visited our website, demonstrated that users interacted with multiple features on the website and survey. User feedback also indicated that the website was easy to navigate and helped make money feel more tangible. Lastly, for habituation, an average of 75.27% of respondents conveyed positive change in spending habits, for we recorded 74.2% accuracy for a question based on the long-term impact, 77.4% accuracy for a question on earning and saving, and 74.2% accuracy on question on the "Pain of Paying." From an evaluation standpoint of our website's favorability, the results also provide insight in areas of preference and distaste. For page ratings, Final Review Form respondents had a collective rating (out of ten) of 7.32 for the Home Page, 7.58 on the Physical Cash Page, 7.45 for the Earning Page, and 7.52 in The Digital Damage Page. Additionally, while the project met most of its intended goals, the data shows repeated interaction can further reinforce long-term behavioral change. Overall, these results suggest that our website successfully addressed the majority of the identified problem and met most of our project's goals.



Prior to the respondents' website use, majority of the awareness was rated at 2 and 3, as depicted in the above pie chart. In the pie chart below, it is evident that the majority of the data falls into the 4 and 5 range, thus reflecting an increased sense of attention to the users' financial literacy and future.



LESSONS LEARNED



	What Worked Well	What Didn't Work Well
Initiating	Clearly identifying the problem and its associated topics helped us create a high-quality focus, relevant solution, purpose, and impact. This strong foundation greatly contributed to the ease and continuity of the following project management steps.	The initial target audience was too broad, and it was harder to focus on such a large audience. In detail, we originally intended to focus on all children aged 5-18, and had our scope set to the entire student body of New Jersey. In the end of this section, we had to refine the demographic before moving forward, which took up more time than expected.
Planning & Organizing	In general, teamwork was strong and coordinated, for tasks were completed by the most qualified member for the respective field. This alignment carried out better quality and content for the project as opposed to random selection or selection by wants.	Time estimates were often improper and slightly unrealistic, which were a detriment to the project's substance. Although we were constantly successful in resolving these time issues, the adjustments were strenuous and demanding, limiting room for quality.
Execution	For phase 2, the website directly and effectively translated financial concepts into relatable examples. Our emphasis on clarity and simplicity maximized impact to the set target audience, which in turn boosted the execution step.	Managing the feedback loop cycle for the Final Review Form came with difficulties because some user input was sent late, delaying implementation time. Unfortunately, these refinements were not fully addressed, meaning we could not entirely fulfill participant feedback. Additionally, it stressed the necessity for marginal days.
Monitoring & Controlling	Regular progress check-ins helped us identify problems quickly and keep us on track. For example, when we realized the Takeaways Page was not completed, the conflict was quickly relayed, allowing the group to redistribute priorities and finish on time.	From the respondents of the baseline survey, 40% of them did not reply to the final review form. We failed to consider their inability to execute all three steps, which resulted in a significant gap in our results.

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR FUTURE PROJECTS

Looking ahead, there are several areas where our project can be developed and enhanced. One key recommendation is to expand the depth and breadth of interactive tools on the website, such as adding more scenario-based situations that reflect everyday financial decisions students commonly face. While the current tools we used introduce the connection between work, time, and effort, future iterations can offer adjustable difficulty levels based on the student's level of financial understanding. Additionally, introducing short videos or animations can help sustain engagement for students with shorter attention spans and enhance comprehension.

Another area for improvement is data collection and evaluation. Although the pre- and post-surveys offer valuable insight, future projects could benefit from a larger sample size to improve the reliability and accuracy of data. Implementing follow up surveys weeks or months after students interact with the website would allow us to assess retention and behavioral changes related to spending habits. Furthermore, refining survey questions to reduce rushed or biased responses could improve data accuracy.



Future projects should allocate additional time to website testing across different devices to ensure full compatibility and accessibility. Incorporating additional accessibility features such as simplified navigation and design for younger students would improve usability. Improving project documentation and time management would strengthen overall execution. By building on these improvements, future versions of the project can be more engaging, user-friendly, and effective in helping students understand the value of money in a tangible manner.



Lastly, although we were able to provide benefit to many participants, our recorded metric may be an understatement. Based on our forms, only 60% of Baseline Survey respondents also replied to the Final Review Form. So, in future projects, creating a method to guarantee that members follow through with the requested tasks, such as setting incentives that motivate users to complete all components, would generate higher accuracy in project data.

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APPENDIX

Baseline Google Form

Final Review

“Behind the Price” Website